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/ T7 INITIATIVE

SOCIAL IMPACT GRANT **CHALLENGE**

WE'RE INVESTING UP TO **\$1.5 MILLION** INTO NONPROFITS.

The future of social impact is built here. T7 connects mission-aligned organizations, institutions, innovators, and changemakers to funding pathways, strategic partnerships, ecosystem visibility, and scalable impact opportunities.

[APPLY FOR THE CHALLENGE ↗](#)

[OFFICIAL RULES & TERMS](#)

/ THE GATEWAY

OPEN ACCESS TO THE **ECOSYSTEM**

For the first time, nonprofit organizations, institutions, workforce leaders, innovators, and mission-aligned organizations from across the country have an opportunity to engage with the T.D. Jakes Foundation ecosystem through funding pathways, strategic partnerships, educational experiences, and national visibility.

**THIS IS MORE THAN A SUMMIT. IT IS THE GATEWAY TO THE T.D. JAKES
FOUNDATION ECOSYSTEM.**

/ WHAT YOU'LL ACCESS

PATHWAYS TO **SCALABLE** IMPACT

01

ECOSYSTEM ACCESS

02

STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIPS

03

AI, LEADERSHIP & INNOVATION

04

**WELLNESS & WORKFORCE
DEVELOPMENT**

05

/ WHO SHOULD APPLY

BUILT FOR THOSE BUILDING IT

- ✓ Nonprofit organizations
- ✓ Workforce & community leaders
- ✓ Mission-aligned organizations
- ✓ Institutions & educational partners
- ✓ Innovators & technologists
- ✓ Changemakers building scalable impact

/ SUBMIT INTEREST

APPLY FOR THE CHALLENGE

ABOUT THE CHALLENGE

The T.D. Jakes Foundation (TDJF), in partnership with Wells Fargo, is proud to launch the **Social Impact Grant Challenge**, a transformative funding opportunity designed to identify, support,



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Designed around the T.D. Jakes Foundation's pillars of service (Educational Access & Workforce Readiness, financial inclusion, and community transformation and well-being), the Challenge seeks innovative nonprofit organizations that are addressing critical social issues through impactful, scalable, and sustainable solutions.

Finalists selected through this process will have the opportunity to showcase their organization through a live presentation at the inaugural Thriving Seven (T7) Summit, taking place November 12th–14th in Atlanta, Georgia.

In addition to competing for grant funding, finalists will gain national visibility for their work and connect with nonprofit leaders, funders, and changemakers from across the country.

TDJF serves as the sole administrator of the Challenge and is responsible for the evaluation, selection, and final determination of award recipients. Wells Fargo serves as a strategic funding partner and does not participate in selection of the award recipients or grant-making decisions.

GRANT FUNDING AVAILABLE

A total of **\$1,500,000** in grant funding is anticipated to be awarded:

ONE (1) \$500,000 GRANT	ONE (1) \$250,000 GRANT
TWO (2) \$100,000 GRANTS	ELEVEN (11) \$50,000 GRANTS

ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS

Only one application may be submitted per organization. To be eligible, organizations must:

- ✓ Provide documentation supporting registered nonprofit organization status in good standing under Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code.
- ✓ Be headquartered and operating within the United States, the District of Columbia, or Puerto Rico.



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- ✓ Comply with all applicable laws, rules, and regulations, including anti-discrimination laws, as an organization.
- ✓ Ensure all programs or activities are open to participants regardless of race, gender, ethnicity, heritage, or similar characteristics.
- ✓ Agree to all Challenge rules, eligibility requirements, and reporting obligations.

There is no purchase, donation, or fee required to enter or participate in the Challenge.

IMPORTANT DATES

APPLICATION OPENS	APPLICATION DEADLINE	FINALIST PRESENTATIONS
JULY 23, 2026 AT 12:00 AM ET	AUGUST 30, 2026 AT 11:59 PM ET	NOVEMBER 12–14, 2026 · ATLANTA, GA

Late or incomplete applications will not be considered.

FUNDING DISTRIBUTION

Grant funding will be distributed to each winner in three phases:

2026	Q2 2027	Q3 2027
50% OF GRANT FUNDS	25% OF GRANT FUNDS	25% OF GRANT FUNDS

FINALIST PARTICIPATION

Selected finalists will be invited to present their organization, mission, impact, and proposed use of grant funds during the Thriving Seven (T7) Summit. TDJF will provide complimentary Summit registration for finalists. Finalists are responsible for all travel-related expenses, including airfare, lodging, ground transportation, meals, and other incidental costs.

EVALUATION CRITERIA



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CRITERIA

WEIGHT

Organizational Impact and Results to Date

25%

Evaluates the organization's ability to clearly communicate its mission, the community it serves, and the impact it has achieved to date.

Alignment with Community and Social Impact Goals

25%

Evaluates how well the organization's mission and proposed project align with the goals of creating positive, meaningful, and lasting community impact.

Soundness and Feasibility of Proposed Use of Funds

25%

Evaluates the clarity and practicality of the proposed use of grant funding, including whether the project demonstrates a thoughtful approach to achieving its intended outcomes.

Organizational Capacity and Sustainability

25%

Evaluates the organization's ability to effectively carry out its proposed project and its commitment to creating lasting impact beyond the grant period.

BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

- ✓ Applications cannot be edited once submitted. Please review all responses carefully before completing your final submission.
- ✓ Submission of an application does not guarantee advancement in the selection process.
- ✓ Applicants are encouraged to retain a copy of their responses for their records.

For a complete list of eligibility requirements, program rules, selection criteria, and grant conditions, please review the [Social Impact Grant Challenge Official Rules](#).

If you have questions regarding the Grant Challenge or the application process, please email events@tdjfoundation.org.

We look forward to learning more about your organization and the impact you are making in communities across the country.



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ORGANIZATION NAME *

STREET ADDRESS *

ADDRESS LINE 2 (SUITE, UNIT, ETC.)

CITY *

STATE / PROVINCE *

ZIP / POSTAL CODE *

COUNTRY *

EIN (EMPLOYER IDENTIFICATION NUMBER) *

AUTHORIZED REPRESENTATIVE

NAME *

TITLE *

EMAIL *



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PHONE NUMBER *

IS YOUR ORGANIZATION CURRENTLY RECOGNIZED AS A 501(C)(3) PUBLIC CHARITY IN GOOD STANDING WITH THE IRS? *

☐ Yes	☐ No
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CAN YOU PROVIDE AUDITED FINANCIALS AND/OR FINANCIAL STATEMENTS FOR THE PAST TWO YEARS UPON REQUEST? *

☐ Yes	☐ No
---------------------------	--------------------------

ORGANIZATION VISION STATEMENT (100 WORDS OR LESS) *

ORGANIZATION MISSION STATEMENT (100 WORDS OR LESS) *

HOW MANY YEARS HAS YOUR ORGANIZATION BEEN IN OPERATION? *

☐ Less than 1 year	☐ 1–2 years
☐ 3–5 years	☐ More than 5 years

☐ \$500,001–\$1 million☐ Over \$1 million**DOES YOUR ORGANIZATION CURRENTLY HAVE A STRATEGIC PLAN OR DOCUMENTED BUSINESS MODEL? ***☐ Yes☐ No

MISSION ALIGNMENT & COMMUNITY IMPACT

WHICH FUNDING PILLAR BEST ALIGNS WITH YOUR PROPOSED PROGRAM? (SELECT ONE) *☐ Financial Inclusion☐ Educational Access and Workforce
Readiness☐ Community Transformation and Well-Being☐ Other**DOES YOUR PROGRAM OR INITIATIVE PROVIDE ANY OF THE FOLLOWING? (SELECT ALL THAT APPLY)**☐ Workforce readiness or job training☐ Industry-recognized credentials or
certifications☐ Apprenticeships or internships☐ Employment placement services☐ Career coaching or mentorship☐ Entrepreneurship or small business
development support☐ Digital skills or technology training☐ Financial literacy or economic
empowerment training☐ None of the above

PROVIDE A BRIEF OVERVIEW OF THE PROPOSED PROGRAM, PROJECT, OR INITIATIVE. INCLUDE THE PROBLEM OR NEED BEING ADDRESSED, THE INTENDED OUTCOMES, AND THE SPECIFIC PERFORMANCE METRICS YOUR ORGANIZATION WILL USE TO TRACK PROGRESS AND MEASURE SUCCESS. (250 WORDS OR LESS) *



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WHICH POPULATION(S) WILL PRIMARILY BENEFIT FROM YOUR PROPOSED PROGRAM? (SELECT ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ Youth

☐ Adults

☐ Returning Citizens

☐ Low-to-Moderate Income Individuals

☐ Families

☐ Seniors

☐ Veterans

☐ Other

WHAT IS THE GEOGRAPHIC REACH OF THE PROGRAM, SERVICE, OR INITIATIVE FOR WHICH FUNDING IS BEING REQUESTED? (SELECT ONE) *

☐ Local Community (neighborhood, municipality, or specific community)

☐ City or County

☐ Regional (multiple counties or multi-city area)

☐ Statewide

☐ National

☐ International

APPROXIMATELY HOW MANY INDIVIDUALS DID YOUR ORGANIZATION DIRECTLY SERVE DURING THE PAST 12 MONTHS? (NUMERICAL INPUT ONLY) *

ARE YOU ABLE TO PROVIDE IMPACT REPORTS, EVALUATION DATA, OR SUCCESS METRICS UPON REQUEST? *

☐ Yes

☐ No



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☐ Midwest

☐ Southwest

☐ West

☐ Not Applicable / Outside of the US

DOES YOUR ORGANIZATION OPERATE WITHIN THE BELOW CITIES?

☐ Dallas

☐ Atlanta

☐ Baltimore

☐ New York

☐ Not Applicable

ORGANIZATIONAL CAPACITY & SUSTAINABILITY

DESCRIBE THE KEY PERSONNEL WHO WILL LEAD, MANAGE, AND IMPLEMENT THE PROPOSED PROGRAM OR INITIATIVE. INCLUDE THEIR ROLES, QUALIFICATIONS, AND RELEVANT EXPERIENCE. *

DOES YOUR ORGANIZATION MAINTAIN AN ACTIVE BOARD OF DIRECTORS THAT MEETS REGULARLY AND PROVIDES OVERSIGHT GOVERNANCE? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

BRIEFLY DESCRIBE YOUR ORGANIZATION'S FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT PRACTICES, INCLUDING HOW GRANT FUNDS ARE TRACKED, MONITORED, AND REPORTED TO ENSURE ACCOUNTABILITY AND COMPLIANCE. (250 WORDS OR LESS) *



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IF SELECTED FOR FUNDING, CAN YOUR ORGANIZATION COMMIT TO COMPLYING WITH ALL GRANT REPORTING REQUIREMENTS, INCLUDING THE TIMELY SUBMISSION OF PROGRESS REPORTS, FINANCIAL REPORTS, AND IMPACT DATA? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

USE OF FUNDS & FEASIBILITY

WHAT IS THE ANTICIPATED COST TO FUND YOUR PROGRAM? (SELECT ONE) *

☐ Under \$50,000

☐ \$50,000–\$99,999

☐ \$100,000–\$149,999

☐ \$150,000–\$249,999

☐ \$250,000–\$349,999

☐ \$350,000–\$500,000

PLEASE EXPLAIN HOW YOU DETERMINED YOUR REQUESTED FUNDING AMOUNT. INCLUDE A BRIEF EXPLANATION OF THE MAJOR EXPENSES THE GRANT WILL SUPPORT, HOW THE AMOUNT REQUESTED ALIGNS WITH YOUR PROJECT BUDGET, AND WHY THIS LEVEL OF FUNDING IS NECESSARY TO ACHIEVE THE PROPOSED OUTCOMES. (250 WORDS OR LESS) *

HAS YOUR ORGANIZATION SUCCESSFULLY MANAGED GRANTS OF A SIMILAR SIZE WITHIN THE PAST THREE YEARS? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

DESCRIBE YOUR ORGANIZATION'S READINESS TO LAUNCH AND MANAGE THE PROPOSED PROGRAM OR INITIATIVE WITHIN SIX (6) MONTHS OF RECEIVING GRANT FUNDING. PLEASE INCLUDE YOUR ANTICIPATED



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LIST THE FUNDERS THAT HAVE SUPPORTED YOUR ORGANIZATION WITHIN THE PAST 24 MONTHS.

INNOVATION & SCALABILITY

DOES YOUR PROPOSED PROGRAM INTRODUCE A NEW APPROACH, EXPAND AN EXISTING SUCCESSFUL MODEL, OR ADDRESS AN UNMET COMMUNITY NEED? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

IF SUCCESSFUL, CAN THIS PROGRAM BE EXPANDED, REPLICATED, OR SUSTAINED BEYOND THE GRANT PERIOD? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

DESCRIBE YOUR ORGANIZATION'S PLAN FOR SUSTAINING THE PROPOSED PROGRAM OR INITIATIVE BEYOND THE GRANT PERIOD. INCLUDE ANTICIPATED FUNDING SOURCES, PARTNERSHIPS, REVENUE STRATEGIES, OR OTHER RESOURCES THAT WILL SUPPORT LONG-TERM SUCCESS AND IMPACT. (250 WORDS OR LESS) *



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By submitting this application, I certify that the information provided is true, complete, and accurate to the best of my knowledge. I further certify that I am authorized to submit this application on behalf of the organization and that the organization meets the eligibility requirements of the T.D. Jakes Foundation Social Impact Grant Challenge. I acknowledge that my organization has reviewed and agrees to comply with the Official Challenge Rules and Eligibility Requirements. I understand that submission of an application does not guarantee selection for funding and that, if selected, my organization may be required to provide additional documentation, participate in due diligence and compliance reviews, execute a grant agreement, and comply with all reporting, evaluation, and impact measurement requirements. I understand that failure to comply with program requirements may result in disqualification or forfeiture of grant funding. I further understand that participation in the Challenge does not guarantee funding, and all awards remain subject to the terms and conditions outlined in the final grant agreement.

Please note: By submitting this application, you will automatically be added to the T.D. Jakes Foundation email communication list to receive updates about the Social Impact Grant Challenge, the T7 Summit, and related initiatives. You may unsubscribe at any time.

☐ **I AGREE**

SUBMIT APPLICATION ↗

By submitting, you agree to be contacted by the T.D. Jakes Foundation regarding the Social Impact Grant Challenge.

THRIVING SEVEN SUMMIT



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NOW 12-14, 2020.

A global convening for visionary leaders shaping the future of communities at scale. Hosted by the [T.D. Jakes Foundation](#).

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